

Medicine created me. But it is my twin sister who made me a medic. In-Vitro Fertilisation not only made me a testament of the remarkable advances in medicine, but by creating my twin it exposed me to the complexities of the brain that sparked my passion for the subject. As a twin, the phenomenon of speaking each other's thoughts and understanding without words led me to ponder upon the anatomy inside us and the intricacies of the human body.

With this sparked curiosity, I found myself attending multiple dissections, ranging from insects and earthworms to more complex organs such as a cow's heart and lungs. Despite only being 15, my familiarity with the procedure meant I was invited by my school to lead a session dissecting a cricket during an inter-school biology day. A year later, my fascination for anatomy and natural leadership led me to perform a VR-simulated laparoscopy at Medical Centre. Utilising specialised equipment like the Veress needle and insufflator was my closest experience to surgery and my first time crossing the boundary between witnessing medicine to being an active participant.

In pursuit of my passion for physiology, I attended the Name expo with preserved human remains and organs in Location. I was perplexed by the precision and decision-making required to successfully operate. Such understanding was only reinforced by my attendance at workshops at University Name, where I handled real human bones and even had the opportunity to conduct an ultrasonography. Determined to gain more experience before university, I participated in an internship at the ICU of Hospital Name, where I had the opportunity to shadow medical staff. Beyond witnessing procedures such as stitching and treating dislocating limbs, I proved myself to possess the passion, sacrifice and commitment required to care for patients.

As an aspiring practitioner, I too share the mission of wanting to help others and alleviate human suffering. At the height of the pandemic, I served my community by organising lectures promoting Covid-19 vaccines and invited medical professionals to speak in local schools. More recently, I contributed to sending humanitarian aid to countries at war. For example, I selected adequate equipment to treat the wounded, and subsequently wrote and translated manuals for their usage outside of the European Union. Witnessing the magnitude of these crises highlighted to me the importance of having the knowledge to preserve life, and that I want to be part of the next generation to carry such knowledge.

Throughout my educational journey, I have consistently attended, competed, and won events related to science and medicine. My Year exposition on the influence of citric acid on roses carried me to the final of Competition, with my commitment to excellence leading to my return in Year where I scored the 12th highest score in Country. Soon after, I was one of the 50 Nationals chosen to attend the Experience, where my performance led to being named as Winner of the Main Prize. Having proved my intellectual abilities, Experience further selected me to represent them on Event, a two-week Location STEM conference. My scientific poster was given recognition amongst 200 projects, and I was invited to give a main stage presentation in front of 500 attendees and a panel of experts which included one of my role models, Name and Position.

Medicine gave me life, it watched me grow, it became a craft I completely immersed into, and now I look forward to carrying its mission through me.

